



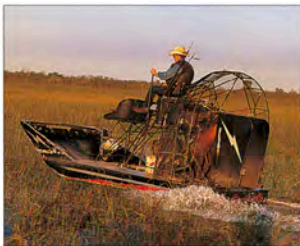
SKIMMING OVER THE WATER



Most boats travel very slowly because the water itself creates a drag on a boat's hull, or body, that slows it down. But hovercraft and hydrofoils just skim across the water, so they can travel at great speed. A hovercraft is not really a boat because it hovers above the surface of the water. It is also amphibious, which means that it can travel on both land and water.

Fan boating

People get around the reed beds and watery forests of the Everglades in Florida using flat-bottomed fanboats. These have raised fan motors that do not get caught in the weeds.



Hovercrafts, like this Landing Craft Air Cushion, are still widely used in the military.

Control cabin



Life rings

What a drag!

Water-skiers can speed over the water, but will slow right down if they fall in. This is because water is more than 800 times denser than air.

